

## (GAME NAME) — Baseline Rules

Version: 2026-04-25. Source of truth for all test scenario rule sheets.

Do not edit this file during a playtest — use the layer-specific rule sheet instead.

---

### Goal

Capture the opponent's **King**. The game ends immediately when a King is removed from the board.

#### Draw conditions:

- No piece has been captured for 10 consecutive full rounds.
- Only the two Kings remain on the board.

---

### Components

**Per player:** 1 King · 5 Champions · 6 Guards

**Shared:** 10×10 grid board (no terrain effects) · Skill tokens or cards · Rune tokens · Round tracker

---

### Setup

1. **Board:** Use the 10×10 grid. Ignore any terrain markings.
2. **First player:** Flip a coin.
3. **Piece placement:** Each player places pieces on their own back two rows:
  - Back row (row 1/10): King in the centre, Champions fill the remaining 5 spaces.
  - Second row (row 2/9): All 6 Guards.
4. **Skill Draft:** Alternating picks. P1 picks 2 skills from the pool and assigns them freely to any of their Champions or King, then P2. Repeat until all Champions and the King on each side have 2 skills each (12 per player). Duplicates allowed.
5. **Starting Runes:** Each player starts with **4 Runes**.
6. P1 begins Round 1.

---

### Round Structure

A **Round** = P1's Turn + P2's Turn.

At the **start of each player's turn** (before they do anything), that player collects their Rune income. (*Exception: Round 1 — players begin with their starting Runes and collect nothing before their first turn.*)

---

### Turn Structure

Each **Turn** has two phases, in order:

1. **Movement Phase** — spend Move Slots to move pieces (and attack).
2. **Action Phase** — spend Skill Slots to activate skills.

You may use 0 slots in either phase.

---

## Movement Phase

You have **2 Move Slots** per turn. Spend 1 Move Slot to move one piece. **Each piece may only be moved once per Movement Phase.**

| Piece           | Normal speed | Injured speed |
|-----------------|--------------|---------------|
| Guard           | 2 tiles      | 1 tile        |
| Champion / King | 1 tile       | 1 tile        |

**Free pathing:** A piece may move in any direction — horizontal, vertical, diagonal — taking any route up to its speed in tiles. The route does not have to be a straight line.

**Pieces block movement:** A moving piece cannot pass through any other piece, ally or opponent.

- *Exception:* A piece may go around a blocking piece if total tiles moved stays within speed (e.g. a Guard using 2 diagonal moves to go around a piece directly in the way).

---

## Standard Attack

To attack, spend a Move Slot to move your piece **onto a tile occupied by an enemy piece.**

- Deal **2 DMG** to the enemy.
- **If the enemy is removed:** your piece occupies the tile.
- **If the enemy survives** (Armor absorbed the damage): your piece stops on the tile immediately before the target.

You may attack with one Move Slot and move a different piece with the other Move Slot in the same turn.

---

## Action Phase

You have **2 Skill Slots** per turn (to start — see Progression).

Spend 1 Skill Slot to activate one equipped skill on one of your Champions or King:

1. Announce the skill and the target.
2. Pay the skill's Rune cost.
3. Apply the skill's effect.

The same Champion can activate multiple skills in one turn if you have Skill Slots remaining.

---

## Skill System

**Skill Path:** Skills travel in a **straight line** (horizontal, vertical, or diagonal) from the caster, like a chess Queen.

**Blocking:** The Skill Path is blocked by **all pieces** — ally and opponent alike. The skill cannot reach past the first piece in its path.

**Range:** The distance in tiles along the Skill Path from caster to target. Range is measured as:

- Range 0 = self (caster's own tile)
- Range 1 = adjacent tile along Skill Path
- Range 2 = 2 tiles away along Skill Path (etc.)

**Default Range = 2.** Unless a skill specifies otherwise.

**Injured Range penalty:** Injured pieces have Skill Range -1. This only affects skills with Range 2 or higher — adjacent (Range 1) and self (Range 0) always work regardless of Injured status.

**Skills that move pieces do not deal damage.** Movement-via-skill (Quick Dash, Shadow Shift, Retreat Plan) does not count as a Standard Attack and deals no damage on arrival.

**A Champion may use its skills multiple times in the same turn** if Skill Slots are available — including the same skill twice.

All skills cost 1 Skill Slot unless noted otherwise.

---

## Resource Economy (Runes)

**Starting Runes:** 4 per player.

Rune income is collected at the **start of each player's own turn**:

| Round | Income per player turn  |
|-------|-------------------------|
| 1     | 0 (starting Runes only) |
| 2–4   | +1                      |
| 5–9   | +2                      |
| 10–14 | +3                      |
| 15+   | +4 (+1 every 5 rounds)  |

**No Rune cap.**

---

## Health & Armor

**All pieces have 2 HP:** Normal → Injured → Removed.

| State   | HP | Effect                                                     |
|---------|----|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Normal  | 2  | No penalty                                                 |
| Injured | 1  | Speed capped at 1. Skill Range –1 (affects Range 2+ only). |
| Removed | 0  | Piece leaves the board permanently.                        |

### Damage:

- 1 DMG to Normal → Injured.
- 1 DMG to Injured → Removed.
- 2 DMG to Normal → Removed instantly (Injured state is skipped).

**Armor:** Max 3 points per piece. Each absorbs 1 DMG, then destroyed. Resolves before HP damage. Does not prevent Injured status.

---

## Bodyguard Rule

When you make a **Standard Attack** against an opponent's Champion or King, the defender may choose to have a Guard intercept — **if a friendly Guard is on a tile adjacent to both the tile immediately before the target (along the attack path) and the defending piece.**

### Interception:

1. Defender announces a Guard to intercept.
2. The Guard takes the damage instead of the original target.
3. The attacker moves **1 tile** toward the target (stops on the tile immediately before the Guard, not before the original target).

**Interception is optional.** The defender may decline even if a Guard is eligible.

Only Standard Attacks can be intercepted. Skills always hit directly.

---

## Skill Drafting

1. Lay out all available skills face-up as a shared pool.
2. Alternating draft: P1 picks 2 skills from the pool and assigns them freely to any of their Champions or King → P2 picks 2 skills and assigns freely → repeat.
3. Continue until all 5 Champions and the King on each side have 2 skills.
4. Both players draft from the same pool. Duplicates are allowed.

---

## Progression

| Round | Skill Slots per turn   |
|-------|------------------------|
| 1–10  | 2                      |
| 11–20 | 3                      |
| 21–30 | 4                      |
| 31+   | 5 (+1 every 10 rounds) |

## Skill Reference

|                                                                                     | Cat.   | Name             | Cost | Effect                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------------|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    | Strike | Lance Thrust     | 2    | Target within Range-1 takes 1 DMG                                                                                                  |
|    | Strike | Hook Pull        | 3    | Target takes 1 DMG, pulled 1 tile toward caster along Skill Path                                                                   |
|    | Strike | Armor Breaker    | 2    | Remove 1 Armor from target                                                                                                         |
|    | Strike | Rune Theft       | 3    | Target takes 1 DMG. Steal 1 Rune from opponent.                                                                                    |
|    | Strike | Blade Tempest    | 4    | Target takes 1 DMG. All pieces adjacent to the target are pushed 1 tile away from the target. The attacker/caster is not affected. |
|    | Shield | Rust Shield      | 2    | Self: gain +1 Armor                                                                                                                |
|    | Shield | Field Medic      | 3    | Remove Injured from one adjacent ally                                                                                              |
|    | Shield | Armorsmith       | 3    | Adjacent ally gains +1 Armor                                                                                                       |
|    | Move   | Quick Dash       | 3    | Self: move up to 2 tiles along Skill Path                                                                                          |
|    | Move   | Air Blast        | 2    | Push target enemy 1 tile directly away from caster                                                                                 |
|    | Move   | Precision Thrust | 3    | Push target enemy 1 tile in any direction (caster chooses). <b>Range+1 (Range 3 at default).</b>                                   |
|    | Move   | Shadow Shift     | 4    | Swap position with an allied piece. Requires unobstructed Skill Path.                                                              |
|   | Move   | Retreat Plan     | 4    | Self: move along Skill Path to land adjacent to one of your Guards. <b>Range+1.</b>                                                |
|  | Mystic | Focus Strike     | 1    | The next skill used by <b>any of your pieces</b> this turn gains +1 Range.                                                         |
|  | Mystic | Blade Call       | 3    | One Strike skill used by <b>any of your pieces</b> this turn deals +1 DMG. Fixed cost: 3 Runes.                                    |

## Quick Reference

| Concept                  | Rule                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Movement                 | Free pathing, ≤ speed in tiles, cannot pass through pieces. Each piece once per phase.                                                  |
| Attack                   | Move onto enemy tile (1 Move Slot). 2 DMG.                                                                                              |
| Attack — target survives | Attacker stops on tile before target                                                                                                    |
| Skill Path               | Straight line (Queen). Blocked by all pieces.                                                                                           |
| Default Skill Range      | Range 2 (unless skill specifies)                                                                                                        |
| Bodyguard                | Guard adjacent to both tile-before-target and defender. Guard takes the damage. Attacker moves 1 tile. Standard Attacks only. Optional. |
| Rune income              | Start of YOUR turn (not Round 1).                                                                                                       |
| Healing                  | No cap. Same piece can be healed multiple times per turn.                                                                               |
| Armor                    | Armor absorbs damage first, then HP                                                                                                     |